

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1134

By Martin G

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Tonya Craft on her distinguished service to the legal profession and the State of Tennessee.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should salute those citizens who, through their extraordinary efforts, have distinguished themselves as community leaders of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such noteworthy person is Tonya Craft, an attorney whose personal experience inspired her to obtain her legal degree and help others pursue truth and justice; and

WHEREAS, after a false accusation of sexual abuse ended her twenty-year career as a kindergarten teacher in 2007, Tonya Craft had to advocate for herself by assembling a team of attorneys and expert witnesses to pursue justice in her case; and

WHEREAS, fighting for the truth for more than two years in the legal system, Ms. Craft was acquitted of all charges in 2010 and subsequently decided to earn a law degree, completing law school and being sworn in as an attorney in 2019; and

WHEREAS, today, Ms. Craft is the head of Tonya Craft Legal Attorneys at Law in Chattanooga, leading her team on their collective mission to practice law differently and obtain justice for their clients; and

WHEREAS, through her estimable service to her community and the legal profession, Ms. Craft epitomizes the spirit and commitment that are characteristic of a true Tennessean; and

WHEREAS, we find it appropriate to acknowledge and applaud Tonya Craft for her dedication to the State of Tennessee and its citizens; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE

CONCURRING, that we specially recognize and honor Tonya Craft, reflecting on her stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction as we commend her meritorious service to her community and this State.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.